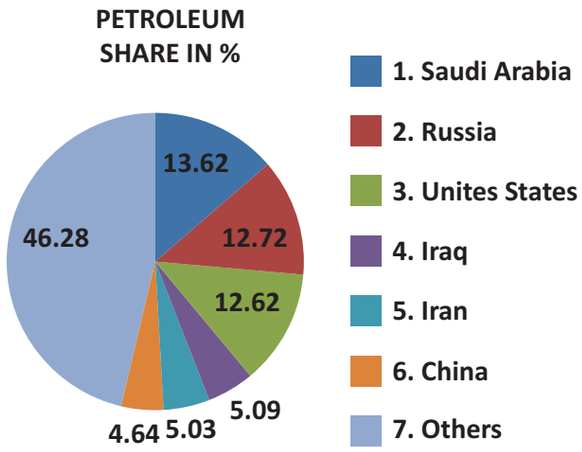
East contains 60% of global reserves and rest of the world only 40%.

Petroleum

Rank	Country	Share in%
1	Saudi Arabia	13.62
2	Russia	12.72
3	USA	12.62
4	Iraq	5.09
5	Iran	5.03
6	China	4.64
	Others	46.28



Trade

The world leading exporters of petroleum are Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, UAE and Canada and the main importers are USA, China, India, Japan and Korea.



OPEC is the short form of the "Organisation of Petroleum Exporting Countries. It was formed in 1960 at Bagdad convention. Initially it comprised of Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, Kuwait and Venezuela. Later on added in eight countries Libya, Algeria, Qatar, UAE, Nigeria, Ecuador and Angola, Indonesia left from OPEC in recently.

Major Petroleum production centres

Country	Production centres
Saudi Arabia	Ghawar, Abquiaq, Abu Hadriya, etc.
Russia	Volga- Caspian region, Kamchatka- Sakhalin region, Ob – Lena basin.
U.S.A	Tennessee- New york, ohio, Indiana, Pennsylvania, Texas, Mississippi, Gulf of California, etc.
Iraq	Kirkuk, Mosul, Daura, etc.
China	Taching, Chinchou, yemen, South china sea, etc.

Natural Gas

It is the cheapest source of energy. It is found along with or without petroleum. It is considered as an environment friendly fuel because of its low carbon dioxide emissions. Therefore, this is the only fuel for the present century and it is also called **green energy.** A powerful odorant, ethanethiol is added, so that leaks can be detected easily. It is prepared by refining petroleum or wet natural gas.

Natural gas reserves and Production

The known natural gas reserves in the world is about 6254 trillion cubic feet. Most of these reserves are found in Russia, Iran, Qatar, UAE, Saudi Arabia, USA etc. USA has the largest reserve and is the leading producer of natural gas in the world. India is the 28th producer of natural gas in the world. It is widely used as a fuel in industries and domestic cooking purposes. Petrochemical industries use it as fuel and raw material. It is also used in chemical industries, artificial rubber, plastic, fertilizers, ink and carbon.

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